

2014-15

THE EUROPEAN UNION FACES AN UNPRECEDENTED MIGRANT CRISIS

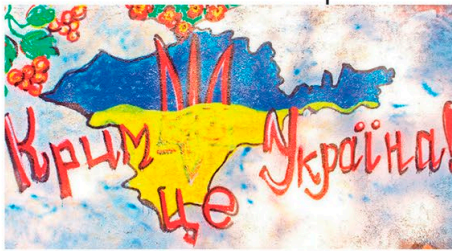
The EU had long been a destination of choice for people fleeing war and persecution, but in 2014-15, numbers increased dramatically. Refugees from wars in Syria and Afghanistan sought to cross EU borders from Turkey, while many thousands more risked their lives by sailing over the Mediterranean in small boats from North Africa. By the end of the year almost a million people had applied for asylum in Germany, the most welcoming host country.

▷ Refugees disembarking onto the Greek Island of Lesbos, 2015



16 September 2014 Civil war breaks out in Yemen between the government and Houthi rebels

2014



△ "Crimea is Ukraine" graffiti

27 February 2014

RUSSIA ANNEXES CRIMEA

Russia's President Putin reacted to the deposing of Ukraine's pro-Russian President Viktor Yanukovich by reviving Russian claims to Crimea, a territory that had been transferred from Russia to Ukraine in 1954. Russian troops were dispatched to install a pro-Russian government that, following a referendum and a declaration of independence, accepted the status of a republic of the Russian Federation.



△ Islamic State supporters celebrate

10 June 2014

ISLAMIC STATE TERRORISTS CAPTURE THE IRAQI CITY OF MOSUL

In the chaotic aftermath of the Iraq War, supporters of the Islamic State of Iraq and the Levant (ISIL), a Sunni insurgent group, took control of Mosul, the most important city in the north of the country, after the government troops defending it fled. The terrorists held it for three years, during which minority groups were brutally oppressed and more than 2,000 people were summarily executed. The Iraqi military, backed by international forces, retook the city after a nine-month campaign.